

Producer Placement Operations

Standard Operating Procedure & Playbook

Keyman Publishing, LLC · Licensed to Vox Nova, LLC

Status moves on evidence, not on emails.

The artist's signed SoundExchange LOD, with its certificate of completion, must be received **before** the producer signs the producer agreement.

Version 1.0 · 2026-09-30

Internal operations document — not legal, tax or accounting advice.

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Part 1 — Overview

Producer Placement Operations

Keyman Publishing, LLC · Licensed to Vox Nova, LLC

A delegated playbook for taking a producer placement from the first email to **contracted, paid, and SoundExchange LOD active**, with proof at every step.

The one rule that makes it work

Status moves on evidence, not on emails. LOD sent ≠ LOD signed ≠ certificate verified ≠ active at SoundExchange. Contract sent ≠ producer signed ≠ fully executed. Invoice sent ≠ "OK to pay" ≠ paid.

The Vox Nova sequencing rule

The artist's signed SoundExchange LOD, with its certificate of completion, must be received before the producer signs the producer agreement. (Status P5 LOD GATE — HOLD.)

Start here

1. New email or file about a placement → `workflows/placement-intake.md`
2. Work the placement with → `checklists/operator-checklist.md`
3. Words for every email → `templates/`
4. Stuck, a conflict, or a deadline → `workflows/escalation.md`

Settings (filled in by Vox Nova management)

Setting	Value
Escalation Owner (name, email)	_____
Backup Escalation Owner	_____
Placements folder location	_____
Standard follow-up clock	FU1 3 BD → FU2 +3 BD → escalate +2 BD
Release countdown escalation	≤10 BD with any gate item open
Payment check after invoice acknowledged	10 BD (or the promised date, if sooner)
SoundExchange active re-check	every 10 BD, escalate after 3
Weekly review day	Monday

Contents

producer-placement-ops/	
README.md	← you are here
SOP.md	roles, flow, timers, document control, legal boundary
intake/	
placement-intake-template.md	the master placement record (copy per song)
required-fields.md	minimum data by stage
workflows/	
placement-intake.md	P0 → P2 intake, term snapshots, confirmations
contracting.md	P2 → P8 contracting info, reconciliation, LOD gate, execution
soundexchange-lod.md	LOD request → certificate verification → active
payment.md	vendor setup → route → invoice → paid-confirmed
pre-release-gate.md	RELEASE READY vs BLOCKED
escalation.md	16 triggers (E-01 ... E-16) + how to escalate
templates/	email wording + send / reply / no-reply rules
checklists/	operator, payment, LOD, release-readiness
data/	
status-definitions.md	every status + the evidence needed to enter it
placement-schema.md	field definitions
placement-tracker.csv	one row per placement (header only)
historical-basis.md	the 4 audited placements behind each rule

Boundaries

- Operations controls only. **Not legal, tax or accounting advice.** Terms, clearance judgments and disputes go to the producer's attorney through the Escalation Owner.
- The operator never signs, agrees to terms, releases signature pages, handles bank details, receives funds, or tells a label whether it can release.
- Placement records, contacts and the tracker are internal and are never published.

Source

Built 2026-09-30 from four producer placement email audits (Cases 1–4). See `data/historical-basis.md`. Follow-up timers are Vox Nova policy; the historical record showed silences, not a working cadence.

SOP — Producer Placement → LOD → Contract → Payment → Release

Licensors: Keyman Publishing, LLC · **Licensee:** Vox Nova, LLC **Applies to:** every song where a Vox Nova producer client is credited as a producer **Version:** 1.0 — 2026-09-30

1. Purpose

Take a placement from the first email to a closed file, and be able to prove every step with a document. The operator's job is not to believe that something happened. It is to **collect the proof that moves the placement to its next status**.

2. Operational controls, not legal advice

This SOP is an operations checklist. It does not interpret contracts, decide what terms are fair, or give legal, tax or accounting advice. Whenever this SOP says "compare" or "reconcile," the operator checks that the words and numbers are the **same**. Deciding whether a difference is acceptable belongs to the producer and their attorney, through the Escalation Owner.

The operator **never**: - signs anything, for anyone - agrees to, proposes or changes any deal term - releases a producer's signature pages - gives payment or bank details, or changes a payment route - tells a label the song can or can't be released - receives or forwards producer advances

3. Roles

Role	Who (typically)	What they do in this flow
Operator	Vox Nova staff	Runs this SOP: records, requests, follow-ups, evidence, status.
Escalation Owner	Named in README.md → Settings	Decides everything in workflows/escalation.md.
Producer client	Vox Nova's producer	Confirms terms, answers sample questions, signs through their attorney.
Producer attorney	Producer's counsel	Negotiates, handles signature pages, often sends invoices.
Label business affairs	Label legal/business affairs	Sends terms and drafts, collects contracting info, circulates execution copies.
Artist attorney	Artist's counsel	Often drafts the producer agreement; gets the artist to sign the LOD.
Label A&R admin / payments	Label A&R administration / accounts payable	Vendor forms, PO, payment release, remittance.
Co-producers' teams	Other producers' reps	Must confirm splits; sign their own agreements.

4. The flow at a glance

```

WHAT CAME IN? ————— P0 NEW (audio only / no terms → P0-U UNPAPERED)
| workflows/placement-intake.md
WHAT DATA DO I EXTRACT? — P1 TERMS REVIEW (Term Snapshot, quotes, UNKNOWNs)
|
WHAT IS MISSING? ————— P2 TERMS CONFIRMED (every producer confirms + samples + collaborators)
|                               └─ Payment Track: start vendor setup now
| workflows/contracting.md
WHO DO I CONTACT? ————— P3 CONTRACTING (contracting info out; LOD requested NOW)
|
WHAT DOCUMENT DO I NEED? — P4 EXECUTION VERSION RECEIVED (reconcile to confirmed terms)
| workflows/soundexchange-lod.md
|                               P5 LOD GATE – HOLD (producer does NOT sign)
WHAT PROVES COMPLETION? — P6 LOD RECEIVED (artist-signed LOD + certificate verified)
|
|                               P7 PRODUCER SIGNED
|                               P8 FULLY EXECUTED (every signature line)
| workflows/payment.md workflows/soundexchange-lod.md §6
HAS THE PRODUCER BEEN PAID? → Payment Track → PAID-CONFIRMED
HAS THE LOD BEEN EXECUTED? → SX Track → SUBMITTED → ACTIVE-CONFIRMED
| workflows/pre-release-gate.md
IS THE SONG RELEASE-READY? – P9 RELEASE READY (or BLOCKED – DO NOT MARK RELEASE READY)
|
|                               P10 COMPLETE (paid + SX active + evidence audit + registration
hand-off)

IF NOT, WHO DO I ESCALATE TO? → workflows/escalation.md

```

The LOD rule: the artist's signature on the SoundExchange Letter of Direction, with its certificate of completion, must be in **Vox Nova's hands before the producer signs the producer agreement**. This is the producer's only leverage to get the LOD. After the producer signs, the artist side has no reason to hurry (historical case C3: three requests, no certificate).

5. Timers (business days = BD)

Clock	Rule
Standard request	No reply in 3 BD → Follow-Up #1. No reply 3 BD after FU1 → Follow-Up #2. No reply 2 BD after FU2 → escalate (E-13).
New inbound placement email	Record created same BD ; Term Snapshot within 1 BD .
Producer signature pages released	Receipt confirmed by the other side within 2 BD , or FU1.
Fully executed copy	Not received 10 BD after the producer signed → FU1 to the label, then the standard clock.
LOD signed after the certificate is verified	SoundExchange submission proof within 10 BD ; active confirmation checked every 10 BD until confirmed.
Invoice → payment	Check at 10 BD after the invoice is acknowledged (or on the label's promised date, if sooner). Then the standard clock.
Release countdown	Any gate item open at ≤10 BD to release → escalate (E-12) the same day.
Record review	Every open record reviewed weekly (Monday). Update "Next action" and "Last updated."

6. Document control

6.1 Folder per placement

```

Placements/
  KM-2026-0001 - <Artist> - <Song>/
    00_Record/                placement-record.md, comms-log.md, escalations.md
    01_Deal_Terms/            TS-1_..., TS-2_..., producer confirmations
    02_Clearance/             sample answers/forms, collaborator confirmations, session/legal-
info forms, stems delivery proof
    03_Agreement/
      drafts/                  every draft/redline, dated
      execution-version/       the reconciled execution PDF + reconciliation sheet
      producer-signed/         producer-signed PDF + e-sign certificate
      fully-executed/          final PDF, all signatures
    04_SoundExchange_LOD/     LOD request, artist-signed LOD, Certificate of Completion,
verification sheet, SX submission, SX active proof
    05_Vendor_Setup/          W-9, label vendor/registration forms, rejections, approval
    06_Payment/                invoice(s), PO, promised-date emails, remittance/bank proof – one
sub-folder per obligation
    07_Release/                release-date proof, pre-release gate sheet
    99_Correspondence/         saved emails (PDF), named by date + subject

```

6.2 File naming

YYYY-MM-DD_<doc-type>_<party>_<status>.pdf e.g. 2026-10-14_LOD_ArtistName_SIGNED.pdf, 2026-10-14_LOD-Certificate_ArtistName.pdf, 2026-10-20_Agreement_FULLY-EXECUTED.pdf.

6.3 Handling rules

- Save every email that changes status as a PDF in 99_Correspondence/.
- Open every attachment that the record depends on. Take facts from the document, not from the email describing it.
- Never overwrite: new versions get a new date prefix.
- Bank account numbers, IDs and tax IDs are **never** typed into the record or tracker. Store only the file the label received, in 05_Vendor_Setup/.
- Contact lists, placement records and the tracker are internal. They are never posted, published or shared outside Vox Nova, the producer, and the producer's attorney.

6.4 Six-month test (done at P10)

Another operator, opening only the folder, can prove:

Question	Where the proof is
What was agreed?	03_Agreement/fully-executed/ (+ Term Snapshots for history)
Who produced?	Credit line + co-producer confirmations in 01_Deal_Terms/
Who owns what?	Executed agreement splits + 02_Clearance/
What was signed, by whom, when?	Signed PDFs + e-sign certificates
What was paid?	06_Payment/ remittance matched to invoice
What went to SoundExchange, and is it active?	04_SoundExchange_LOD/ submission + active proof
Who signed the LOD? Does the certificate exist?	Artist-signed LOD + verified certificate
Is anything outstanding?	00_Record/placement-record.md → Outstanding items (empty)

7. After COMPLETE — publishing hand-off

At P10, send the internal registration hand-off (song, all writers and producers, confirmed publishing shares from the executed agreement, ISRC if known, release date) to Vox Nova's registration workflow. Registration is a separate

process. This SOP only guarantees that the split data sent comes from the executed agreement.

8. Where everything lives

Need	File
Start a new placement	intake/placement-intake-template.md, intake/required-fields.md
Step-by-step per stage	workflows/*.md
Email wording	templates/*.md
Daily checkbox list	checklists/operator-checklist.md
Status meanings	data/status-definitions.md
Field definitions	data/placement-schema.md, data/placement-tracker.csv
Why the rules exist	data/historical-basis.md

Status Definitions & Transition Rules

Every placement has exactly **one Placement Status** at a time, plus two parallel **Track Statuses** (Payment, SoundExchange) that open after the agreement is fully executed.

A status moves forward **only when the evidence in the "Required to enter" column is saved in the placement folder** (see ../SOP.md §6 Document Control). An email that *describes* an event is not evidence of the event.

1. Placement Status (main line)

#	Status	Meaning	Required to ENTER this status (evidence)
P0	NEW	Something about a possible placement came in.	Placement record created with source email/file saved to 99_Correspondence/.
P0-U	UNPAPERED	Only an audio file, title match, or verbal mention exists — no commercial terms in writing.	Record created; "What should be verified next" filled in. Stays here until written terms arrive.
P1	TERMS REVIEW	Written deal terms received; being extracted and checked.	Term Snapshot #1 saved (01_Deal_Terms/) with the exact quoted sentence for each term.
P2	TERMS CONFIRMED	Every producer on the song has confirmed the same terms in writing, and samples/collaborators are answered.	(a) Written "confirmed" reply from each producer or their rep, referencing the snapshot version; (b) written sample answer from the producer side (none / list); (c) written collaborator answer; (d) no open Contradiction Flag.
P3	CONTRACTING	Contracting info delivered; agreement being drafted / negotiated.	Contracting-info email sent (saved) and acknowledged, or first draft agreement received.
P4	EXECUTION VERSION RECEIVED	The final, clean agreement for signature is in hand and reconciled to confirmed terms.	Execution-version PDF saved in 03_Agreement/ + Terms Reconciliation completed with every field = MATCH (or each difference approved in writing by the Escalation Owner).
P5	LOD GATE — HOLD	Waiting for the artist-signed SoundExchange LOD before the producer signs. Producer must NOT sign in this status.	Execution version reconciled (P4). Applies whenever LOD Required = YES.
P6	LOD RECEIVED	Artist-signed LOD and its certificate of completion are in hand and verified.	(a) LOD PDF with artist signature; (b) e-signature Certificate of Completion for that envelope; (c) LOD Verification (workflow soundexchange-lod.md §4) all PASS.
P7	PRODUCER SIGNED	Producer has signed the agreement.	Producer-signed PDF and the e-signature certificate (or scanned wet-ink pages). A drawn/pasted image signature does not count.
P8	FULLY EXECUTED	All parties have signed.	Fully executed PDF showing every signature line signed (including inducement letters and exhibits that require signatures). "OK to pay", "we'll circle back with the executed copy", or a partially executed copy do not count.
P9	RELEASE READY	Everything required before release is done.	Pre-release gate (../checklists/release-readiness-checklist.md) = all required items PASS.
P10	COMPLETE	Placement fully closed.	Payment Track = PAID-CONFIRMED and SoundExchange Track = ACTIVE-CONFIRMED (or N/A with reason) and evidence package audit passed and registration hand-off sent.

Side statuses (can be set from any P-status)

Status	When to set	How to leave it
BLOCKED	Any required item can't move without someone else acting and a follow-up rule has run out, or an escalation trigger fires. Record the blocker in one sentence.	Blocker resolved with evidence → return to the prior P-status.
ESCALATED	An escalation trigger in <code>./workflows/escalation.md</code> fires.	Escalation Owner writes a decision in the record → return to the prior P-status or move to CLOSED.
RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS	The song came out before P9. (This happened in all 3 of the papered historical cases.) Keep the P-status too, e.g. P7 / RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS.	Reach P10.
CLOSED — NOT PLACED	Written confirmation that the song won't use the producer's work, or the Escalation Owner closes it.	—

Rules that never bend

1. **No producer signature before P6** when LOD Required = YES. If anyone asks the producer to sign first, escalate (trigger E-10).
2. **No skipping.** P5 → P7 is not allowed. P3 → P7 is not allowed.
3. **Terms change = back to P1.** If any term changes after P2, create a new Term Snapshot, set a Contradiction Flag, and go back to TERMS REVIEW.
4. **Status only moves on evidence.** If the evidence isn't in the folder, the status doesn't move, whatever the email says.

2. Payment Track (opens at P2, completes after P8)

Vendor setup can start as soon as terms are confirmed, so paperwork isn't what holds up payment later.

Status	Required to enter
PAY-NOT STARTED	—
VENDOR SETUP IN PROGRESS	Vendor/payee forms requested by the label (e.g. W-9, label vendor or registration form, tax portal) saved to <code>05_Vendor_Setup/</code> .
VENDOR SETUP CONFIRMED	Written confirmation from the label's admin that the vendor/payee record is created or approved. "Looks good to submit" = still IN PROGRESS.
ROUTE CONFIRMED	One payee entity + one bank route for each obligation, confirmed in writing by the label, matching the agreement's payment-direction letter (if any).
INVOICED	Invoice PDF saved, with invoice #, amount, payee entity, PO # (if the label uses POs), and the send email saved. Only allowed at or after P8, unless the Escalation Owner approves in writing.
PAYMENT PROMISED	Label states a payment date / "OK to pay" / PO issued. Not payment.
PAID-CONFIRMED	Bank deposit record or remittance advice showing amount, payer, and date , matched to the invoice #. An ACH notice with no amount or payer does not count.
PAY-DISPUTED	Amount received ≠ invoice amount, or a duplicate/conflicting payment route exists → escalate (E-08 / E-09).

Each obligation gets its own row: producer advance, legal fee invoice, any other invoice. Never merge them.

3. SoundExchange Track

Status	Required to enter
SX-N/A	Written reason saved (e.g. agreement has no SoundExchange LOD and the producer's attorney confirms none is due). Only the Escalation Owner can set this.
LOD REQUESTED	Request email saved (template <code>lod-request.md</code>).
LOD SENT FOR SIGNATURE	E-sign envelope notice or the other side's email saying it was sent, saved.
LOD SIGNED BY ARTIST	Artist-signed LOD PDF saved.
CERTIFICATE VERIFIED	Certificate of Completion saved and all verification checks PASS. = Placement P6.
SUBMITTED TO SOUNDEXCHANGE	Proof of who submitted the LOD to SoundExchange and when (submission email, portal screenshot, or SoundExchange case/ticket email).
ACTIVE-CONFIRMED	SoundExchange email or a dated portal screenshot showing the LOD active for the named payee. A signed LOD + certificate alone are not proof that SoundExchange has it on file.

4. Evidence ≠ Claims — quick reference

What someone says	What status it proves
"I sent the LOD"	LOD SENT FOR SIGNATURE at most
"He signed it"	Nothing until the signed PDF is saved
Signed LOD PDF	LOD SIGNED BY ARTIST — not CERTIFICATE VERIFIED
Certificate of Completion	CERTIFICATE VERIFIED — not ACTIVE at SoundExchange
"Contract sent"	Nothing for execution
Partially executed copy	Not FULLY EXECUTED
"OK to pay" / PO issued / "should land Wednesday"	PAYMENT PROMISED
Invoice sent	INVOICED
Remittance advice or bank deposit matching the invoice	PAID-CONFIRMED

Part 2 — Workflows

Workflow 1 — Placement Intake & Terms (P0 → P2)

Trigger

Any of these arrives for a Vox Nova producer client: - a label/business-affairs email with a song title + terms, or a request for producer details - an attorney email about a producer agreement - a "which producers / any samples / contracting info" email - an audio file, stems request or title mention with **no** terms

Step 1 — Create the record (same business day) → P0 NEW

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Search the tracker for the artist + song (and alternate titles). If a record exists, add the thread to it. Don't create a duplicate.	Tracker search done	—	If none exists, create one
Create the folder <code>Placements/KM-YYYY-NNNN - Artist - Song/</code> from §6.1 of the SOP	Folder exists	P0	Save the source email
Save the source email as PDF in <code>99_Correspondence/</code>	PDF saved	P0	Fill out the intake template
Fill in <code>intake/placement-intake-template.md</code> : every field known, UNKNOWN for everything else	Record saved	P0	Step 2

If there are no commercial terms in writing (audio only, title match, "we're using the beat"): set **P0-U UNPAPERED**, fill in "What should be verified next," and send `templates/missing-information-followup.md` Version A to the person who sent the file or their label contact. Check that the song isn't a different song with the same title (historical case C4). Leave the record at P0-U until written terms arrive.

Step 2 — Extract terms → P1 TERMS REVIEW (within 1 BD)

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Create Term Snapshot TS-1 in <code>01_Deal_Terms/</code> : for each term, copy the exact sentence and note the email date + sender	TS-1 file saved	P1	Check for gaps
For each term, mark it STATED, UNKNOWN or UNCLEAR. Publishing must say whether the % is each producer or total . If the wording doesn't say, mark UNCLEAR.	TS-1 complete	P1	Check for contradictions
Compare against earlier emails in the thread and any other thread for the same song. Any difference → Contradiction Flag OPEN + new snapshot TS-2	Flag recorded	P1	If OPEN → escalate (E-01)
List every producer credited or mentioned. Anyone not already known → trigger E-05	Producer list saved	P1	Step 3

Minimum terms to get to P2 (all STATED, none UNCLEAR): advance total, all-in yes/no, advance allocation, master points/royalty + allocation, producer client's publishing share (each vs total), credit line, all producers named.

Step 3 — Confirm terms, samples and collaborators → P2 TERMS CONFIRMED

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Send templates/producer-terms-confirmation.md to the producer client (cc producer attorney), quoting the snapshot	Sent email saved	P1	Start the 3-BD clock
Send the same snapshot to each co-producer's rep and ask them to confirm the split	Sent emails saved	P1	Clock
Get the producer's own written answer: samples (none / list) and other collaborators (none / list)	Reply saved in 02_Clearance/	P1	If a sample or interpolation → E-06
If the label sent a sample-clearance sheet or session/legal-info form, get it filled in and returned	Returned form saved	P1	—
All confirmations received, flag CLEARED	Confirmation files listed in the record	P2	Open the Payment Track (payment.md Step 1); go to contracting.md

What counts as a confirmation: an email reply that says "confirmed" (or equivalent) and refers to the snapshot sent. A thumbs-up emoji, a phone call, or "looks good" on a different email does not count. Ask again, quoting the snapshot.

No reply: follow SOP §5. At escalation, set BLOCKED ("co-producer split unconfirmed"). Historical case C3 lost 63 days here.

Exit

P2 reached → workflows/contracting.md.

Workflow 2 – Contracting (P2 → P8)

The producer's LOD gate sits inside this workflow (P5 → P6). Details of the LOD itself: [soundexchange-lod.md](#).

Step 1 – Contracting information → P3 CONTRACTING

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Collect from the producer/attorney: contracting entity legal name, signer, entity address, producer legal name + p/k/a, PRO + IPI, publishing designee, SoundExchange payee entity, attorney contact, notice address	intake/required-fields.md §C complete	P2	Send to the label
Send templates/contracting-info-request.md Version B (the info package) to label business affairs, cc producer attorney. In the same email, request the SoundExchange LOD (see soundexchange-lod.md Step 1).	Sent email saved	P3	3-BD clock for acknowledgment
Log every draft or redline that arrives in 03_Agreement/drafts/ with date + sender	Drafts saved	P3	Forward to the producer attorney if they weren't copied

The operator doesn't negotiate. Redlines go between the attorneys. The operator tracks who holds the draft ("ball in court") and runs the clock on that person.

Step 2 – Execution version → P4 EXECUTION VERSION RECEIVED

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Save the clean execution PDF in 03_Agreement/execution-version/	PDF saved	P3	Reconcile
Fill in the Terms Reconciliation (below): confirmed snapshot vs execution PDF, field by field	Reconciliation sheet saved	P3	All MATCH → P4. Any DIFFERENT → E-07
List every exhibit/schedule. Any marked "to be provided separately" or blank → record as outstanding	Exhibit list in the record	P3	Missing exhibit → E-07
Check every name and entity is spelled the same as the contracting info sent	Name check PASS	P3	Misspelling → ask business affairs to correct before signing
Everything PASS	—	P4	→ P5

Terms Reconciliation sheet

Field	Confirmed snapshot (TS-n)	Execution PDF (page/\$)	MATCH / DIFFERENT / MISSING
Advance total			
All-in			
Producer client's advance share			
Points / royalty total			
Producer client's points share			
Publishing share (each/total)			
Credit line			

Field	Confirmed snapshot (TS-n)	Execution PDF (page/\$)	MATCH / DIFFERENT / MISSING
Co-producers named			
Contracting entity			
Payee entity / payment-direction letter			
SoundExchange LOD included? payee + %			
Exhibits complete?			

Only the Escalation Owner can accept a DIFFERENT line, in writing.

Step 3 — LOD GATE → P5 HOLD → P6 LOD RECEIVED

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Set P5 LOD GATE — HOLD . Tell the producer and their attorney in writing: "Please hold signature until the artist-signed LOD and certificate are received."	Hold email saved	P5	Chase the LOD
Run <code>soundexchange-lod.md</code> Steps 2–4 until the artist-signed LOD + certificate are verified	Verification sheet all PASS	P5	→ P6
If anyone asks the producer to sign first, or says the LOD will come "after," don't agree. Escalate.	Email saved	P5 + ESCALATED	E-10
LOD verified	—	P6	Tell the producer's attorney the gate is cleared

If LOD Required = NO (set by the Escalation Owner only, with a reason), P5/P6 are skipped and P4 → P7 is allowed.

Step 4 — Producer signature → P7 PRODUCER SIGNED

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Producer signs through their attorney using a verified e-signature platform (with a certificate) or wet ink, scanned	Signed PDF + certificate saved in <code>producer-signed/</code>	P7	Confirm receipt
Confirm the other side received the signature pages	Their written acknowledgment saved	P7	None in 2 BD → FU1 (historical C3: pages sat 28 days)

Step 5 — Full execution → P8 FULLY EXECUTED

Action	Evidence required	Status	Next action
Request the fully executed copy (<code>templates/missing-information-followup.md</code> Version C) if not received 10 BD after P7	Request saved	P7	Standard clock
When received, check every signature line: all parties, inducement letters, payment-direction letters, LOD exhibit	Fully executed PDF + checklist saved	P8	Open <code>payment.md</code> Step 3 and <code>soundexchange-lod.md</code> Step 5

"OK to pay," "we'll circle back with the fully executed copy," and a copy signed by both producers but not the label or artist are **not** P8.

Workflow 3 — SoundExchange Letter of Direction (LOD)

What this is (operations view)

A SoundExchange LOD is signed by the **featured artist**. It directs SoundExchange to pay a share of the artist's digital-performance royalties to the producer's named payee. Only the artist can sign it, so the producer depends on the artist side to get it done. That's why Vox Nova requires it **before** the producer signs the producer agreement. Whether an LOD is due, and what percentage, is set by the producer agreement. The operator doesn't decide either one.

Timing rule

P3 CONTRACTING — request the LOD (Step 1)
 P4 EXECUTION VERSION — LOD wording in the agreement reconciled
 P5 LOD GATE – HOLD — producer does NOT sign
 P6 LOD RECEIVED — artist-signed LOD + certificate verified
 P7 PRODUCER SIGNS

Step 1 — Request (at P3) → LOD REQUESTED

Who sends	Operator
To	Artist attorney (or label business affairs if the artist attorney isn't known), cc producer attorney
Template	templates/lod-request.md Version A
Asks for	(1) the LOD form SoundExchange will accept, filled in with the producer's payee entity and % from the agreement; (2) the artist's signature through a verified e-signature platform; (3) the Certificate of Completion for that envelope; (4) confirmation of who will submit it to SoundExchange
Attachments	Payee details sheet (entity legal name, contact email, and the SoundExchange account holder name, if known). No bank details.
Complete when	The other side confirms in writing who is preparing the LOD
No response	Standard clock (3 / 3 / 2 BD) → E-13

Step 2 — Sent for signature → LOD SENT FOR SIGNATURE

Evidence: e-sign envelope notification, or the other side's email saying it was sent, with the date. Save it. This is **not** a signature.

Step 3 — Signed → LOD SIGNED BY ARTIST

Evidence: the LOD PDF with the artist's signature, saved as YYYY-MM-DD_LOD_<Artist>_SIGNED.pdf. If only "he signed it" arrives, reply with lod-request.md Version B (request the PDF + certificate).

Step 4 — Certificate verification → CERTIFICATE VERIFIED (= P6)

Save the Certificate of Completion as YYYY-MM-DD_LOD-Certificate_<Artist>.pdf, then fill in this sheet and save it as LOD-Verification.md:

#	Check	PASS / FAIL
1	The certificate is the platform's own audit/completion page (not a screenshot of an email)	
2	The envelope/document ID on the certificate matches the LOD PDF (or the certificate lists the LOD document name)	
3	The signer name on the certificate = the featured artist named on the LOD	
4	The status shows Completed , with a completion timestamp	
5	The signature on the LOD is a platform e-signature or wet ink — not a pasted image	
6	Payee entity on the LOD = the SoundExchange payee in the executed/execution agreement	
7	The % on the LOD = the % in the agreement	
8	Song title(s) and artist name are spelled correctly; ISRC present if the form asks for it	
9	Retroactive/effective-date wording matches the agreement (if the agreement says anything about it)	
10	Names are spelled exactly as in the contracting info (historical C3: a payment-direction letter had to be re-signed over a misspelled name)	

Any FAIL → send `lod-request.md` Version C (correction request) and stay in P5. Checks 6, 7 or 9 FAIL → also escalate E-11.

All PASS → **P6 LOD RECEIVED**. Tell the producer's attorney that the signature hold is lifted.

Step 5 — Submission to SoundExchange → SUBMITTED TO SOUNDEXCHANGE

After P8, confirm **in writing who submits the LOD to SoundExchange** (the artist side, the artist's attorney, or the producer side). Evidence: the submission email to SoundExchange, a SoundExchange case/ticket email, or a dated portal screenshot. No proof within 10 BD of P6 → FU1 to whoever agreed to submit.

Step 6 — Active confirmation → ACTIVE-CONFIRMED

Evidence: a SoundExchange email or dated portal screenshot showing the LOD active for the payee entity. Check every 10 BD until confirmed. After **3 checks** with no confirmation → escalate E-11.

A signed LOD + certificate is not proof that SoundExchange has it on file. In a separate engagement, signed LODs existed that SoundExchange did not have.

Blockers & escalation

Situation	Action
Artist side refuses to send the LOD before the producer signs	E-10. The operator does not release the hold.
LOD can't be obtained after FU2	E-11
Certificate missing but the signed PDF exists	Stay in P5; Version B; E-11 at the end of the clock
Release date ≤10 BD and still in P5	E-12
Payee entity on the LOD ≠ agreement	E-11 (never "fix" it yourself)

Workflow 4 — Payment (Payment Track)

Principles

- Vox Nova **tracks** payment. It doesn't receive, hold or redirect a producer's advance unless a signed agreement says so.
- One obligation = one row: producer advance, legal-fee invoice, any other invoice.
- The amount due comes from the **executed agreement**, not from an email.
- Payment is **confirmed** only by a remittance or bank record showing amount + payer + date, matched to the invoice.

Step 1 — Start vendor setup (at P2) → VENDOR SETUP IN PROGRESS

Historical cases show vendor paperwork holding up payment after the contract was done (C2 outdated tax form; C3 form rejected for its signature type and form version). Start it early.

Action	Evidence required	Next action
Ask label A&R admin/payments which vendor forms they need for the producer's payee entity (templates/payment-request.md Version A)	Sent email saved	Standard clock
Get the forms from the label this time . Never reuse an old copy (outdated versions get rejected).	Blank forms saved in 05_Vendor_Setup/	Producer completes them
The producer (or their entity signer) completes and signs using a verified e-signature platform or wet ink. Notarization / ID only if the form asks.	Completed forms saved	Producer or attorney submits
Check that the tax form (W-9 or equivalent) is current and in the payee entity's exact name	Check noted in the record	—
Label confirms the vendor record is created/approved	Confirmation saved	VENDOR SETUP CONFIRMED

Rejection → save the rejection, note the reason in the record, fix only what the label named, and resubmit on the form version the label sent with the rejection.

Step 2 — Confirm the payment route → ROUTE CONFIRMED

Check	PASS when
Payee entity on the invoice = payee in the agreement's payment-direction letter (if any) = vendor record	All three the same
Only one active route for each obligation	No second payment-direction letter, factoring/advance-company letter, or bank change is in progress
Label has confirmed the route in writing	Email saved

Any second route (for example a third-party payment-direction letter, or a request for a new vendor form with different bank details) → **E-09** before anything is invoiced. Historical C3: two routes ran at once, which risked a double payment or a hold.

Step 3 — Invoice (at or after P8) → INVOICED

Who sends	Producer's entity or producer attorney (as the agreement says). The operator prepares; the producer approves.
To	Label payments contact named in the executed agreement / by business affairs
Contains	Invoice #, date, payee entity, song, artist, amount from the executed agreement , PO # if the label issued one
Complete when	The label acknowledges receipt in writing
No response	Standard clock → E-13

Invoicing before P8 only with the Escalation Owner's written approval.

Step 4 — Chase to confirmed payment → PAYMENT PROMISED → PAID-CONFIRMED

Event	Status	Operator action
"OK to pay" / PO issued / "payment should go out by ..."	PAYMENT PROMISED	Record the promised date
Promised date passes, or 10 BD after acknowledgment with no date	PAYMENT PROMISED	payment-request.md Version C (status request), then the standard clock
Producer or attorney reports funds received	—	Ask for the remittance advice or bank line (amount, payer, date). A screenshot is OK, with account numbers hidden.
Evidence matches invoice #, amount and payer	PAID-CONFIRMED	Save to 06_Payment/<obligation>/
Amount differs, payer unclear, or a duplicate payment	PAY-DISPUTED	E-08

Co-producer paid, producer client not: if the label confirms payment to another producer on the same song while ours is open (historical C2), send Version C the same day and start the clock at FU1.

Payment checklist

See ../checklists/payment-checklist.md.

Workflow 5 — Pre-Release Gate (→ P9 RELEASE READY)

What the gate does and doesn't do

The gate decides whether **Vox Nova marks the placement RELEASE READY in its own records**. It does not stop a label from releasing a song, and the operator never tells a label whether it can release. In every papered historical case (C1, C2, C3) the song came out before the paperwork was finished, so the gate's practical job is to **escalate early** and to record honestly what was outstanding when the song came out.

When to run it

- Every time the release date is learned or changes
- Weekly for any placement with a release date
- Daily once the release is ≤ 10 BD away
- On release day

The gate

Use `../checklists/release-readiness-checklist.md`. Each line is PASS, FAIL or N/A (N/A only with the reason and the Escalation Owner's initials).

#	Item	PASS evidence
1	Terms confirmed	P2 confirmations saved; Contradiction Flag CLEARED
2	Producer identities confirmed	Every producer named, with a contracting entity; no unknown producer
3	Publishing confirmed	Share stated as each or total, in the executed agreement
4	Master points confirmed	Points/royalty + allocation in the executed agreement
5	Samples cleared / confirmed none	Producer's written answer; any sample has a clearance record from the label
6	Other collaborators identified	Written collaborator answer; no new names since
7	Artist-signed LOD + certificate verified before the producer signed	P6 date $\leq$ P7 date
8	Contract fully executed	P8 PDF, every signature line
9	Payment status confirmed	PAID-CONFIRMED, or vendor setup confirmed + route confirmed + invoice acknowledged, with written Escalation Owner acceptance that payment follows release
10	LOD submitted to SoundExchange	Submission proof saved
11	Documents stored	Folder audit (SOP §6.4) passes for everything done so far
12	No unresolved producer-rights issue	No open escalation; no open Contradiction Flag

Result

- **All PASS (or approved N/A)** → set **P9 RELEASE READY**.
- **Any FAIL** → the record shows:

BLOCKED – DO NOT MARK RELEASE READY
Failing items: #__, #__
Release date: YYYY-MM-DD (__ BD away)
Owner of each item: ...

and: - release **>10 BD** away → run the normal follow-up clocks - release **≤10 BD** away → escalate **E-12** the same day, and send `templates/pre-release-clearance.md` to the label/artist attorney only if the Escalation Owner approves - release has **happened** → set **RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS**, list the open items, and keep working the clocks toward P10

Note: item 10 (submission) can PASS without SoundExchange confirming the LOD is active. Active confirmation is required for **P10 COMPLETE**, not P9.

Workflow 6 — Escalation

How to escalate

1. Set the side status **ESCALATED** and log it in 00_Record/escalations.md:

E-ID: E-__ Raised: YYYY-MM-DD Placement: KM-__ - Artist - Song
 Trigger: (one sentence)
 Evidence: (file names)
 Options I can see: (optional – facts only, no recommendation on terms)
 Deadline pressure: release date / promised date
 Decision needed by: YYYY-MM-DD

2. Send it to the **Escalation Owner** (README → Settings) the same business day, with the evidence files attached or linked.
3. Don't take any outside action on the escalated point until the decision is written in the record. Other steps on the placement keep running.
4. No decision in **2 BD** → resend, marked "second request." No decision in **2 BD** more → raise it at the next weekly review, first item.

Triggers

ID	Trigger	Operator does NOT...
E-01	Deal terms conflict across emails, snapshots or parties (incl. "each" vs "total" publishing)	pick the version that looks right
E-02	A producer's identity or contracting entity can't be verified	guess the entity
E-03	Publishing percentages don't add up across all writers/producers	adjust anyone's share
E-04	Master points / royalty don't add up	adjust the allocation
E-05	A new collaborator, writer or producer appears	add them to the split
E-06	A sample or interpolation is discovered	describe its clearance status to the label
E-07	Execution version differs from confirmed terms, or an exhibit is missing / "to be provided separately"	send the producer's signature
E-08	Payment amount ≠ agreed amount, payer unclear, or a duplicate payment	tell anyone to return or keep money
E-09	More than one payment route, a payment-direction letter to a third party, or a bank-detail change	submit any vendor/bank form
E-10	Anyone asks the producer to sign before the artist-signed LOD + certificate arrive	release the hold
E-11	LOD can't be obtained, certificate missing after FU2, LOD payee/% ≠ agreement, or not active after 3 checks	edit or resend the LOD

ID	Trigger	Operator does NOT...
E-12	Release ≤10 BD away with any pre-release gate item FAIL, or the song released while items were open	tell the label to stop or delay
E-13	No response after Follow-Up #2 on any request	send a Follow-Up #3 on their own
E-14	Label, artist team or co-producer disputes the terms	argue the terms
E-15	Anyone asks Vox Nova to sign, accept terms, give bank details or receive funds	do it
E-16	A document has a misspelled name or wrong entity	"fix" the document themselves

Priority

Priority	Triggers	Owner response expected
Urgent (same day)	E-10, E-12, E-09, E-15	Same BD
High	E-01, E-05, E-06, E-07, E-08, E-11, E-14	≤2 BD
Normal	E-02, E-03, E-04, E-13, E-16	≤2 BD

Legal line

When the decision needs a legal, tax or accounting judgment, the Escalation Owner routes it to the producer's attorney or accountant. The operator writes down the decision and who made it, never the reasoning behind a legal position.

Part 3 — Intake

Required Fields — Minimum Data by Stage

Missing a field on the list for a stage → the placement can't enter that stage. Use `templates/missing-information-followup.md` to ask for it.

A. To create a record (P0)

- ☐ Artist
- ☐ Song (and any alternate title)
- ☐ Producer client (Vox Nova)
- ☐ Source: email subject + date, or file name + date
- ☐ Who sent it (name, role, company, email)

B. To confirm terms (P2)

- ☐ Every producer on the song, with their rep
- ☐ Advance total + currency
- ☐ All-in: yes / no
- ☐ Advance allocation (each producer's amount)
- ☐ Master points / royalty total + allocation
- ☐ Producer client's publishing share — **each or total** stated
- ☐ Credit line (exact wording)
- ☐ Samples: producer's written answer
- ☐ Interpolations: producer's written answer
- ☐ Other collaborators / writers: producer's written answer
- ☐ Written confirmation from each producer (or their rep)
- ☐ Label / distributor
- ☐ Label business-affairs contact

C. Contracting information package (P3) — collected from the producer side

- ☐ Producer legal name + p/k/a
- ☐ Contracting entity legal name (as registered) + entity type + state
- ☐ Authorized signer name + title
- ☐ Notice address + notice email
- ☐ Producer attorney: firm, name, email
- ☐ PRO + writer IPI (store as text, keep leading zeros)
- ☐ Publishing designee / publisher name + publisher IPI (if any)
- ☐ Payee entity for the advance (if different from the contracting entity, say why)
- ☐ SoundExchange payee entity (the name the LOD will use)
- ☐ Credit line as the producer wants it
- ☐ Any session/legal-info/sample form the label sent, filled in

Never collected into the record: bank account/routing numbers, tax IDs, ID documents. Those go straight onto the label's own forms.

D. To reach the LOD gate (P5/P6)

- ☐ Artist attorney contact
- ☐ Featured artist legal name (the LOD signer)
- ☐ LOD payee entity + % (from the execution version)
- ☐ Who will submit the LOD to SoundExchange

E. For payment

- ☐ Label payments / A&R admin contact
- ☐ Vendor forms the label requires (current versions)
- ☐ Payee entity name exactly as on the tax form
- ☐ PO # (if the label uses POs)
- ☐ Invoice amount = executed agreement amount

F. For release

- ☐ Release date (actual or announced) + source
- ☐ ISRC (if available)

Placement Record — KM-_-_-

Copy this file to Placements/KM-YYYY-NNNN — Artist — Song/00_Record/placement-record.md. UNKNOWN = no document states it. N/A — reason (source) only with a reason. Every term needs a Source: file name + date.

Status: P__ Side status: __ Next action: ____ Owner: __ Due: _-_- Last updated: _-_- by ____

A. Placement

Field	Value	Source
Artist		
Song (working / final)		
Alternate titles		
Project		
Release date (announced/actual)		
Label / distributor		
Label business affairs		
Label payments / A&R admin		
Artist attorney		
Management		
Producer client		
Contracting entity		
Payee entity (advance)		
SoundExchange payee entity		
Producer attorney		
Co-producers (name — rep — entity)		
Credit line		
First source (subject, date)		

B. Deal — Term Snapshots

Term	TS-1 (date)	TS-2 (date)	Confirmed (TS-_)	Quote / source
Advance total				
All-in?				
Advance allocation				
Points / royalty total				
Point allocation				
Publishing — client share (each/total)				
Writer / publisher share				
Other backend / fees				

Contradiction Flag: OPEN / CLEARED — note: _____ **Confirmations:** producer client ☐ (file) · co-producer 1 ☐ · co-producer 2 ☐ · ...

C. Clearance

Item	Answer	Source
Samples		
Interpolations		
Other collaborators		
Additional writers		
Additional producers		
Sample / session / legal-info forms		
Stems requested / delivered		

D. Contracting

Item	Date	File
Contracting info sent		
Drafts received (list)		
Execution version received		
Terms Reconciliation PASS		
Exhibits outstanding		
LOD gate cleared (P6)		
Producer signed (P7) + certificate		
Receipt of producer pages confirmed		
Fully executed (P8)		

E. Payment

Obligation	Amount (per agreement)	Payee	Vendor setup	Route confirmed	Invoice # / date	PO	Status	Paid date / amount	Evidence
Producer advance									
Legal fee									

F. SoundExchange

Item	Date	File
LOD required (Y/N — who decided)		
LOD payee + %		
LOD signer (artist)		
Requested		
Sent for signature		
Signed by artist		

Item	Date	File
Certificate received		
Certificate verified (initials)		
Submitted to SoundExchange (by whom)		
Active confirmed		

G. Release

Item	Value
Release date	
Days to release (at last check)	
Pre-release gate	PASS / BLOCKED — DO NOT MARK RELEASE READY
Outstanding items (one per line, with owner)	
Final clearance status	

H. Follow-up log

Date	To	Request	FU level	Response?

I. Escalations

ID	Trigger	Raised	Decision	Decided by / date

J. Correspondence

Date	Subject	From → To	Saved file

K. What should be verified next (UNPAPERED records only)

-

Part 4 — Email Templates

Template — Producer Terms Confirmation (P1 → P2)

Who sends: Operator **To:** Producer client (Version A) / each co-producer's rep (Version B) **Cc:** Producer attorney
Attachments: none (terms quoted in the body) **Counts as complete:** a reply saying the terms are confirmed, referring to TS-__; sample + collaborator answers in writing **No reply:** FU1 at 3 BD → FU2 at +3 BD → escalate E-13 at +2 BD
Escalate immediately if: the reply changes any number (E-01), names a new person (E-05), or mentions a sample (E-06)

Fill `{{fields}}` **only** from the Term Snapshot. If a term is UNKNOWN, keep the line and write "Not yet stated — please confirm."

Version A — to the producer client

Subject: `{{Artist}}` – "`{{Song}}`" – please confirm terms (TS-`{{n}}`)

Hi `{{Producer first name}}`,

Below are the terms for "`{{Song}}`" by `{{Artist}}`, as sent by `{{Sender / company}}` on `{{date}}`. Please confirm that each line is correct, or tell us what's different.

- Advance: `{{amount}}` `{{all-in / not all-in}}`, split `{{allocation}}`
- Master points / royalty: `{{total}}`, split `{{allocation}}`
- Publishing: `{{your share}}` `{{each / total for all producers}}`
- Credit: "`{{credit line}}`"
- Producers on the record: `{{list}}`

Two more questions the label will need answered in writing: 1. Were any samples or interpolations used? If yes, list the source for each. 2. Did anyone else work on the production or writing (other producers, writers, musicians)?

Please hold off on signing anything until we confirm the paperwork is complete.

Thanks, `{{Operator name}}` Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Version B — to a co-producer's rep

Subject: `{{Artist}}` – "`{{Song}}`" – split confirmation (TS-`{{n}}`)

Hi `{{Name}}`,

We represent `{{Producer client}}` on "`{{Song}}`" by `{{Artist}}`. To keep the paperwork moving with `{{label / attorney}}`, can you confirm the split as we have it?

- Advance: `{{amount}}` `{{all-in}}`, split `{{allocation}}`
- Points: `{{total}}`, split `{{allocation}}`
- Publishing: `{{as stated}}`
- Credit: "`{{credit line}}`"

A quick "confirmed" is all we need. If anything is different, please tell us what you have.

Thanks, `{{Operator name}}` Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Template — Contracting Information (P2 → P3)

Version A — request TO the producer side (inbound collection)

Who sends: Operator → producer client, cc producer attorney **Attachments:** none **Counts as complete:** every item in `intake/required-fields.md` §C answered **No reply:** FU1 3 BD → FU2 +3 BD → E-13 +2 BD

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – contracting info needed

Hi {{Producer first name}},

The terms are confirmed. To have the agreement drafted, the label needs:

1. Your legal name and producer name
2. The company that signs (exact registered name, entity type, state) and who signs for it
3. Notice address and email
4. Your attorney's name, firm and email
5. Your PRO and IPI number
6. Your publishing company / designee and its IPI (if any)
7. The company that should receive the advance (if it's different from #2, let us know why)
8. The company name to use as SoundExchange payee on the artist's Letter of Direction

Please **don't** email bank or tax ID numbers. Those go directly on the label's vendor forms when they send them.

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Version B — package TO the label (outbound), with the LOD request

Who sends: Operator → label business affairs (and artist attorney if drafting), cc producer attorney **Attachments:** none required; attach the label's own session/legal-info form if they sent one **Counts as complete:** written acknowledgment, or a first draft received **No reply:** FU1 3 BD → FU2 +3 BD → E-13 +2 BD

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – producer contracting info ({{Producer p/k/a}})

Hi {{Name}},

Here is the contracting information for {{Producer p/k/a}} on "{{Song}}":

- Producer: {{legal name}} p/k/a {{p/k/a}}
- Contracting entity: {{entity}}, {{type}}, {{state}} — signer: {{name, title}}
- Notice: {{address}} / {{email}}
- Counsel: {{attorney, firm, email}}
- PRO / IPI: {{PRO}} / {{IPI}}
- Publishing designee: {{publisher}} ({{IPI}})
- Advance payee: {{entity}}
- SoundExchange LOD payee: {{entity}}
- Credit: "{{credit line}}"

SoundExchange Letter of Direction: please send the artist's LOD to {{SoundExchange payee}} for signature along with the draft. The producer will sign the agreement once the artist-signed LOD and its e-signature certificate of completion have been received.

Please also send the vendor forms needed to set up {{payee entity}} so we can have them completed early.

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Template — SoundExchange LOD

Who sends: Operator **To:** Artist attorney (or label business affairs if unknown) **Cc:** Producer attorney **Attachments:** payee details sheet (entity legal name, contact email, SoundExchange account holder name if known) — **no bank details** **Counts as complete:** artist-signed LOD PDF + Certificate of Completion that pass `workflows/soundexchange-lod.md §4` **No reply:** FU1 3 BD → FU2 +3 BD → E-11 +2 BD **Escalate immediately if:** asked to have the producer sign first (E-10); payee or % differs from the agreement (E-11)

Version A — initial request (sent at P3, or with contracting info)

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – SoundExchange LOD for {{Producer p/k/a}}

Hi {{Name}},

Per the producer agreement for "{{Song}}", please prepare the artist's SoundExchange Letter of Direction in favor of {{SoundExchange payee entity}} at {{% per agreement}} and route it to {{Artist legal name}} for e-signature.

Once it's completed, please send us: 1. the signed LOD (PDF), and 2. the e-signature Certificate of Completion for that envelope.

{{Producer p/k/a}} will sign the producer agreement once both are received. Please also let us know who will submit the LOD to SoundExchange.

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Version B — "it's signed" but documents missing

Subject: RE: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – SoundExchange LOD

Hi {{Name}},

Thanks for confirming. Could you send the signed LOD PDF and the Certificate of Completion from {{platform}}? We need both on file before {{Producer p/k/a}} signs.

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Version C — correction needed

Subject: RE: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – SoundExchange LOD correction

Hi {{Name}},

We reviewed the signed LOD. One item needs correcting before it can be submitted:

- {{exact item, e.g. "Payee is listed as X; the agreement names Y" / "Name spelled 'X' should be 'Y'"}}

Could you send a corrected LOD for signature? {{Producer p/k/a}}'s signature remains on hold until the corrected LOD and its certificate are received.

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Version D — submission / active status (after P8)

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – LOD submission to SoundExchange

Hi {{Name}},

Checking in on the LOD for "{{Song}}": has it been submitted to SoundExchange? If you have the submission confirmation or SoundExchange's case number, please forward it.

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Template — Payment

Who sends: Operator (Versions A, C); the producer entity or producer attorney sends the invoice itself (Version B), prepared by the operator **To:** Label A&R administration / payments contact **Cc:** Producer attorney **Counts as complete:** A = vendor forms received; B = invoice acknowledged; C = remittance (amount + payer + date) **No reply:** FU1 3 BD → FU2 +3 BD → E-13 +2 BD **Escalate immediately if:** a second payment route appears (E-09); the amount differs from the executed agreement (E-08)

Version A — vendor setup (at P2)

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – vendor setup for {{payee entity}}

Hi {{Name}},

{{Producer p/k/a}} is producing "{{Song}}" for {{Artist}}. To avoid delays at payment, can you send the current vendor/payee forms you need for {{payee entity}}? We'll get them completed and returned.

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Version B — invoice cover (at/after P8)

Subject: Invoice {{#}} – {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – {{payee entity}}

Hi {{Name}},

Attached is invoice {{#}} for {{amount}}, the {{obligation, e.g. producer advance}} for "{{Song}}" under the fully executed agreement dated {{date}}, PO {{#}}. Payment goes to {{payee entity}}, per the vendor record set up on {{date}}.

Please confirm receipt and the expected payment date.

Thanks, {{Name / entity}}

Version C — payment status

Subject: RE: Invoice {{#}} – {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}"

Hi {{Name}},

Following up on invoice {{#}} ({{amount}}), submitted {{date}} — you'd mentioned payment by {{promised date}}. Can you confirm whether it has been paid, and send the remittance advice with the payment date and amount?

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Template — Missing Information & Follow-Ups

Follow-up clock (all requests): - **FU1** — 3 BD after the original with no reply → reply **on the same thread** - **FU2** — 3 BD after FU1 → same thread, add the producer attorney if not copied - **Escalate** — 2 BD after FU2 → E-13. The operator never sends an FU3.

Log every follow-up in the record (§H) with the date and FU level.

Version A — unpapered placement (P0-U)

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – paperwork

Hi {{Name}},

Thanks for sending "{{Song}}". Before anything moves forward on {{Producer p/k/a}}'s production, can you tell us:

1. Is the record being released, and through which label or distributor?
2. Who is handling the producer paperwork on your side?
3. Proposed terms (advance, points, publishing, credit)?

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

Version B — FU1 / FU2 (any request)

Subject: RE: {{original subject}}

Hi {{Name}},

Following up on the note below. We still need:

- {{item 1}}
- {{item 2}}

{{FU2 only: "Copying {{attorney}} for visibility."}}

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Version C — fully executed copy

Subject: RE: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – fully executed agreement

Hi {{Name}},

{{Producer p/k/a}}'s signed pages went over on {{date}}. Can you send the fully executed agreement, with all signatures, when it's countersigned?

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Version D — receipt of signature pages (2 BD after P7)

Subject: RE: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – signature pages

Hi {{Name}},

Just confirming you received {{Producer p/k/a}}'s signed pages sent {{date}}.

Thanks, {{Operator name}}

Template — Pre-Release Clearance

Version A — internal gate result (always; to the Escalation Owner)

Subject: [GATE] KM-{{id}} – {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – {{PASS / BLOCKED}} – release {{date}} ({{n}} BD)

```
Gate result: RELEASE READY
            - or -
BLOCKED – DO NOT MARK RELEASE READY
```

```
Failing items:
#{{n}} {{item}} – owner: {{party}} – last action {{date}} ({{FU level}})
#{{n}} ...
```

```
Release date: {{date}} ({{n}} BD)
Escalation: E-12 raised {{date}}
Evidence folder: {{path}}
```

Version B — open items notice to the label/artist attorney

Send ONLY with the Escalation Owner's written approval. To: Label business affairs + artist attorney, cc producer attorney **Counts as complete:** each listed item delivered with evidence **No reply:** standard clock → back to the Escalation Owner

Subject: {{Artist}} – "{{Song}}" – open producer items before {{release date}}

Hi {{Name}},

Ahead of the {{release date}} release of "{{Song}}", these items for {{Producer p/k/a}} are still open on our side:

- {{e.g. Artist-signed SoundExchange LOD + certificate of completion}}
- {{e.g. Fully executed producer agreement}}
- {{e.g. Vendor setup confirmation for {{payee entity}}}}

Can you let us know when we can expect each one?

Thanks, {{Operator name}} Vox Nova Publishing, LLC

(State only which items are open. Don't describe consequences, rights or legal positions.)

Part 5 — Checklists

Operator Checklist — One Placement, Start to Finish

Format: **ACTION** → **EVIDENCE REQUIRED** → **STATUS** → **NEXT ACTION** Can't check a box? Don't move on. Follow the "if not" rule. Timers: FU1 = 3 BD, FU2 = +3 BD, escalate = +2 BD (SOP §5).

Stage 1 — Intake (P0 → P1)

- ☐ Search the tracker for the artist/song/alternate titles → no duplicate → — → create the record
- ☐ Create the folder + record from the template → folder + placement-record.md → **P0** → save the source email
- ☐ Save the source email as PDF → 99_Correspondence/...pdf → **P0** → decide whether there are terms
- ☐ No written terms? → Version A sent (missing-information-followup) → **P0-U** → wait for terms; weekly review
- ☐ Write Term Snapshot TS-1 with quotes → 01_Deal_Terms/TS-1... → **P1** → check for contradictions
- ☐ Compare with other emails/threads → Flag OPEN/CLEARED written down → **P1** → if OPEN: **E-01**
- ☐ Every producer listed → list in the record → **P1** → unknown name: **E-05**

Stage 2 — Terms confirmation (P1 → P2)

- ☐ Send producer-terms-confirmation A to the client → sent email saved → **P1** → clock
- ☐ Send B to each co-producer rep → sent emails saved → **P1** → clock
- ☐ Producer's written sample answer → reply in 02_Clearance/ → **P1** → sample found: **E-06**
- ☐ Producer's written collaborator answer → reply saved → **P1** → new person: **E-05**
- ☐ Label sample / session / legal-info form returned (if sent) → returned form saved → **P1** → —
- ☐ All confirmations in, Flag CLEARED → files listed in the record → **P2** → Stage 3 + Payment A

Stage 3 — Contracting (P2 → P4)

- ☐ Contracting info collected (contracting-info A) → required-fields §C all filled → **P2** → send package
- ☐ Package + LOD request to the label (contracting-info B) → sent email saved → **P3** → clock
- ☐ Vendor forms requested (payment-request A) → sent email saved → Payment: VENDOR SETUP IN PROGRESS → clock
- ☐ Log each draft/redline → 03_Agreement/drafts/ → **P3** → note who has the draft; clock on them
- ☐ Execution version received → PDF in execution-version/ → **P3** → reconcile
- ☐ Terms Reconciliation all MATCH → sheet saved → **P3** → any DIFFERENT: **E-07**
- ☐ All exhibits present (none "to be provided separately") → exhibit list → **P3** → missing: **E-07**
- ☐ Names/entities spelled correctly → name check PASS → **P4** → Stage 4

Stage 4 — LOD gate (P4 → P6) — producer does NOT sign here

- ☐ Hold email to the producer + attorney → saved → **P5** → chase the LOD
- ☐ LOD requested (lod-request A), if not already done at P3 → saved → SX: LOD REQUESTED → clock
- ☐ Envelope sent to the artist → notice saved → SX: SENT FOR SIGNATURE → clock
- ☐ Artist-signed LOD PDF → 04_SoundExchange_LOD/...SIGNED.pdf → SX: SIGNED BY ARTIST → get the certificate
- ☐ Certificate of Completion → ...LOD-Certificate...pdf → — → verify

- ☐ Verification sheet (10 checks) all PASS → LOD-Verification.md → **P6** → tell the attorney the hold is lifted
- ☐ Anyone asks the producer to sign first → email saved → P5 + ESCALATED → **E-10**

Stage 5 — Execution (P6 → P8)

- ☐ Producer signs (verified e-sign or wet ink) → signed PDF + certificate → **P7** → confirm receipt
- ☐ Receipt confirmed within 2 BD → acknowledgment saved → P7 → if none: missing-information D
- ☐ Fully executed copy (ask at 10 BD with missing-information C) → PDF with every signature → **P8** → Stages 6 + 7

Stage 6 — Payment track

- ☐ Vendor setup confirmed by the label → confirmation saved → VENDOR SETUP CONFIRMED → —
- ☐ Payment route confirmed (one payee, one route) → email saved → ROUTE CONFIRMED → second route: **E-09**
- ☐ Invoice prepared from the executed-agreement amount, producer approves, sent → invoice + send email → INVOICED → clock for acknowledgment
- ☐ Promised date recorded → email saved → PAYMENT PROMISED → check on that date or at 10 BD
- ☐ Remittance/bank proof (amount + payer + date) matched to the invoice → 06_Payment/... → **PAID-CONFIRMED** → —
- ☐ Mismatch → evidence saved → PAY-DISPUTED → **E-08**

Stage 7 — SoundExchange track

- ☐ Who submits to SoundExchange, confirmed in writing → email saved → — → clock
- ☐ Submission proof → saved → SUBMITTED → check active every 10 BD
- ☐ Active confirmation → SoundExchange email / dated screenshot → **ACTIVE-CONFIRMED** → —
- ☐ 3 checks, not active → — → **E-11**

Stage 8 — Release gate

- ☐ Release date known → source saved → — → countdown on the record
- ☐ Run the release-readiness checklist → gate sheet saved → **P9** or BLOCKED → if BLOCKED at ≤10 BD: **E-12**
- ☐ Released before P9 → release proof saved → RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS → keep working the clocks

Stage 9 — Close

- ☐ PAID-CONFIRMED + ACTIVE-CONFIRMED (or approved N/A) → evidence → — → folder audit
- ☐ Six-month test (SOP §6.4) passes → audit noted in the record → — → hand-off
- ☐ Registration hand-off sent (splits from the executed agreement) → email saved → **P10 COMPLETE** → archive the tracker row

Every Monday

- ☐ Open every record not at P10: update days to release, next action, owner, due date, FU level
- ☐ Anything past its FU2 deadline → escalate (E-13)
- ☐ Any release ≤10 BD with the gate BLOCKED → E-12

Payment Checklist — one per obligation

Placement: KM- _ — _ — " _ " **Obligation:** ☐ **Producer advance** ☐ **Legal fee** ☐ **Other:** ____

#	Check	Evidence file	✓
1	Amount due taken from the fully executed agreement (page/§ noted)		☐
2	Payee entity = contracting info = payment-direction letter (if any)		☐
3	Vendor forms are the label's current versions, requested this time		☐
4	Tax form current and in the payee entity's exact name		☐
5	Signatures on vendor forms are verified e-sign (with certificate) or wet ink — no pasted images		☐
6	Vendor record confirmed created/approved by the label, in writing		☐
7	Only ONE payment route for this obligation (no competing payment-direction letters or bank changes)		☐
8	Label confirmed the route in writing		☐
9	PO # received (if the label uses POs)		☐
10	Invoice: #, date, payee entity, song, artist, amount (= #1), PO		☐
11	Invoice approved by the producer before sending		☐
12	Invoice receipt acknowledged by the label		☐
13	Promised payment date recorded (if given)		☐
14	Remittance / bank proof: amount + payer + date		☐
15	Amount received = invoice amount		☐
16	Stored in 06_Payment/<obligation>/		☐

Does NOT count as paid: "OK to pay" · PO issued · "should land by..." · ACH notice without amount/payer · invoice sent · co-producer paid.

Any ☐ at #2, #7 or #15 that can't be checked → escalate (E-09 / E-08).

SoundExchange LOD Checklist

Placement: KM- _ _ _ " _____ "

Before the producer signs (P5 → P6)

#	Check	Evidence file	✓
1	LOD required = YES (or NO set by the Escalation Owner, with a reason)		☐
2	LOD payee entity + % taken from the execution version		☐
3	LOD requested from the artist attorney/label (at P3)		☐
4	Producer + attorney told in writing to hold signature		☐
5	Envelope sent to the artist (notice saved)		☐
6	Artist-signed LOD PDF saved		☐
7	Certificate of Completion saved		☐
8	Certificate is the platform's own completion/audit page		☐
9	Envelope/document ID or document name matches the LOD		☐
10	Signer on the certificate = featured artist on the LOD		☐
11	Status "Completed" + timestamp		☐
12	Signature is platform e-sign or wet ink, not a pasted image		☐
13	Payee on the LOD = agreement		☐
14	% on the LOD = agreement		☐
15	Titles/names spelled correctly; ISRC if required		☐
16	Effective/retroactive wording matches the agreement (if any)		☐
→	All ✓ = P6 LOD RECEIVED. The producer may sign.		

After full execution

#	Check	Evidence file	✓
17	Who submits to SoundExchange, confirmed in writing		☐
18	Submission proof (email / case # / dated screenshot)		☐
19	Active at SoundExchange for the payee (check every 10 BD) — check 1 / 2 / 3		☐
20	All files in 04_SoundExchange_LOD/		☐

"I sent it" ≠ #5. "He signed" ≠ #6. Signed LOD ≠ #7. Certificate ≠ #19.

Release-Readiness Checklist (Pre-Release Gate)

Placement: KM- _ _ - " _ " Release date: -- Business days away: __ Checked: ____--__ by ____

#	Item	PASS / FAIL / N/A*	Evidence file
1	Terms confirmed (all producers, Flag CLEARED)		
2	Producer identities confirmed		
3	Publishing confirmed (each/total stated in the executed agreement)		
4	Master points confirmed		
5	Samples cleared / confirmed none		
6	Other collaborators identified		
7	Artist-signed LOD + certificate verified before the producer signed		
8	Contract fully executed (every signature line)		
9	Payment status confirmed (PAID-CONFIRMED, or setup + route + invoice acknowledged with Escalation Owner acceptance)		
10	LOD submitted to SoundExchange		
11	Documents stored (folder audit so far)		
12	No unresolved producer-rights issue (no open escalation or Flag)		

*N/A only with a reason and the Escalation Owner's initials.

RESULT:

☐ **RELEASE READY** — all PASS / approved N/A → set P9

☐ **BLOCKED — DO NOT MARK RELEASE READY** Failing: ____ ≤10 BD to release → E-12 raised _-_- Already released → RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS

This is an internal operations status. It is not legal advice and not an instruction to any label about releasing the song.

Part 6 — Data

Master Placement Record – Schema

One record per **song × producer client**. If the same song arrives in several threads, it is still **one** record; link each thread under **Correspondence**. If one email covers several songs, create one record per song and note "shared terms — see Term Snapshot in " instead of copying the numbers.

Fill-in copy: `../intake/placement-intake-template.md`. Spreadsheet version: `placement-tracker.csv` (one row per record).

Value rules - Write **UNKNOWN** when no document states it. Never guess. - Write **N/A** only with a reason, e.g. **N/A – no samples** (producer email 2026-10-02). - Every term field has a **Source** sub-field: file name in the placement folder + date. - Dates are **YYYY-MM-DD**. - Percentages are written the way the document writes them, plus a normalized value, e.g. "25% of their shit split evenly" → **UNRESOLVED**.

A. PLACEMENT

Field	Type	Notes
Placement ID	text	KM-YYYY-NNNN (year of intake + sequence)
Artist	text	As billed on release
Song	text	Working title + final title if different
Alternate titles	list	e.g. "Luv U" / "Love You"
Project	text	Album / EP / single / UNKNOWN
Release date	date	Actual or announced; mark (announced) or (actual)
Label / distributor	text	
Label business-affairs contact	role + email	Drafts/sends the agreement
Label payment / vendor contact	role + email	Vendor forms, PO, remittance
Artist attorney	firm + email	
Management	text	
Producer client (Vox Nova)	text	Legal name + p/k/a
Producer's contracting entity	text	Entity that signs the agreement
Producer's payee entity	text	Entity that receives the advance — may differ from contracting entity
Producer's SoundExchange payee	text	Entity named on the LOD — may differ again
Producer attorney	firm + email	
Co-producers	list	Name, rep, contracting entity, each
Credit line	text	Exact wording, e.g. "Produced by X & Y"
Source of placement	text	First email / file, date

B. DEAL (from Term Snapshots — latest confirmed version)

Field	Notes
Term Snapshot version	TS-1, TS-2, ... Never overwrite an earlier snapshot.
Advance (total)	Amount + currency
All-in?	YES / NO / UNKNOWN

Field	Notes
Advance allocation	Split method + each producer's dollar amount
Master royalty / points (total)	e.g. 3 points / 4%
Point allocation	Each producer
Publishing (producer client share)	% + whether it is each producer or total for all producers
Writer share / publisher share	If stated separately
Other backend / fees	e.g. legal fee invoice, other invoices
Contradiction Flag	OPEN / CLEARED. OPEN if any field differs between snapshots or between parties.
Confirmation evidence	File name of each producer's written confirmation

C. CLEARANCE

Field	Notes
Samples	NONE (confirmed) / YES — list / UNKNOWN
Sample form / clearance sheet	File + date returned
Interpolations	same as above
Other collaborators	List + role
Additional writers	List
Additional producers	List (anyone not in Co-producers above = trigger E-05)
Session / legal-info form	Requested? Returned? File
Stems delivered	Requested date / delivered date / to whom / evidence

D. CONTRACTING

Field	Notes
Contract type	Producer agreement / deal memo / amendment / other
Contract status	Mirrors placement status P3–P8
Drafts received	List: date, version, from
Execution version date	
Terms Reconciliation	PASS / FAIL + file
LOD gate cleared date	Date P6 reached
Producer signed date	+ certificate file
Fully executed date	+ file
Exhibits requiring signatures	List each (e.g. inducement, payment-direction letter, LOD exhibit) + status
Exhibits "to be provided separately"	List + received date (open = trigger E-07)
Contract location	Folder path

E. PAYMENT (one block per obligation)

Field	Notes
Obligation	Producer advance / legal fee / other
Amount due	From the executed agreement , not an email

Field	Notes
Payee entity	Must match the payment-direction letter, if one exists
Payment route	Bank/processor — record route name only , never account numbers
Competing routes?	YES / NO. YES = trigger E-09
W-9 / tax form	Sent date; current? (portal "outdated tax form" notices count)
Vendor setup	Form name, submitted date, rejected (reason), approved date
Invoice # / date / amount	
PO #	If the label uses POs
Payment Track status	See status-definitions §2
Payment date / amount received	From remittance or bank record
Payment evidence	File name

F. SOUNDEXCHANGE

Field	Notes
LOD required	YES / NO / UNKNOWN. Default YES for any master-royalty deal; only the Escalation Owner sets NO.
LOD source	Exhibit in the agreement / standalone
LOD payee entity + %	As written on the LOD
Who signs the LOD	Artist (featured performer) name
LOD requested date	
LOD sent date	
LOD signed date	
Certificate of Completion received	date + file
Certificate verified	PASS / FAIL + checker initials + date
Certificate stored	Folder path
Submitted to SoundExchange	Who / date / evidence
Active confirmed	Date + evidence

G. RELEASE

Field	Notes
Release date	
Days until release	Recomputed at every check-in
Pre-release gate status	PASS / BLOCKED
Outstanding items	Bullet list — one line each, with owner
Final clearance status	RELEASE READY / RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS / COMPLETE

H. CONTROL

Field	Notes
Placement status	P0–P10 + side status
Next action	One sentence + due date
Next action owner	Operator / producer / producer attorney / label / artist attorney
Follow-up counter	FU0 / FU1 / FU2 per open request
Escalations	ID, trigger, date raised, decision, date decided
Correspondence	Thread subjects + dates + links
Last updated	date + initials

Historical Basis — Why the SOP Is Built This Way

This SOP was built from four email audits of past producer placements (Sep 2026). People's names and deal amounts are left out on purpose; the full audits are kept separately by the Escalation Owner.

Case	Placement	What the record showed
C1	Case 1 (major label, 2025–26)	Terms by email in 6 days. Execution version arrived 4 months later. Producer signed Jan 20; fully executed copy 46 days after that. Song was already out before execution. Invoice sent 54 days after execution; 11 weeks after the invoice, repeated follow-ups still had no payment and no reply. No SoundExchange LOD ever started . No W-9 request found. Publishing % never stated in email.
C2	Case 2 (major label, 2024)	Terms changed across 3 versions ; the publishing wording contradicted itself ("25% each" vs "25% split evenly") and was never resolved in writing. The label asked for sample details; the producer side never answered in writing. Agreement came 5 months after terms; producer signed the next day; no fully executed copy found. Co-producer's invoice got a rush; the producer's invoice got no reply. A label tax-portal notice said the tax form was outdated. No LOD ever raised .
C3	Case 3 (major label, 2026)	Artist's attorney wouldn't draft for 63 days until the co-producer's team confirmed the equal split; the producer's attorney followed up about 11 times. Producer signed before the artist's LOD arrived, then asked for the LOD certificate of completion 3 times (Aug 3, Aug 31, Sep 10). None received . Producer's signed pages sat 28 days without being received. Label vendor form rejected (drawn signature, outdated form version). Two payment routes ran at once (contract payee vs a separate payment-direction letter), and one of those letters needed re-signing because the name was misspelled. "OK to pay" Sep 10 → PO Sep 21 → "should land Wednesday" Sep 28 → no receipt found. Song released and later taken down while unpapered.
C4	Case 4 (independent)	Only an audio file. No terms, contract, invoice or LOD in the mailbox. Possible terms sit inside publisher amendment and statement attachments that nobody has opened. A different song with the same title exists.

Lessons → controls

Lesson (case)	Control in this SOP
Producer signed first and lost all leverage to get the artist's LOD (C3).	LOD GATE (P5) : the artist-signed LOD + certificate must be received before the producer signs.
LOD never raised at all (C1, C2).	LOD Required defaults to YES; LOD is requested when contracting starts, not after release.
Signed LODs are not the same as LODs on file at SoundExchange (seen in a separate engagement).	SoundExchange Track ends at ACTIVE-CONFIRMED, not at "signed."
Co-producer split unconfirmed → 63-day drafting stall (C3).	P2 requires written confirmation from every producer before contracting info goes out.
Terms drifted across versions; publishing contradiction never fixed (C2).	Numbered Term Snapshots, never overwritten; Contradiction Flag blocks P2.
Sample question unanswered by producer side (C2).	P2 requires the producer's own written sample answer.
"Fully executed" assumed from an email; PDF never opened (C1). Fully executed copy never received (C2, C3).	P8 requires the fully executed PDF with every signature line checked.
Signed pages lost in transit for 28 days (C3).	After producer signature: confirm receipt within 2 business days.
Vendor form rejected for signature type and outdated form (C3); tax form outdated (C2).	Vendor setup starts at P2; verified e-signature only; always use the form version the label sends <i>this time</i> .

Lesson (case)	Control in this SOP
Two payment routes at once; misspelled name on a payment-direction letter (C3).	ROUTE CONFIRMED status; any second route = escalation E-09; name check on every signed document.
"OK to pay", PO, "should land" treated as progress (C3).	PAYMENT PROMISED ≠ PAID-CONFIRMED.
Invoice silence for 11 weeks (C1); co-producer paid first (C2).	Fixed payment follow-up clock; escalate at FU2.
Songs released before paperwork in every papered case (C1, C2, C3).	Release-date countdown triggers escalation at 10 business days; RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS status.
Audio-only "placement" (C4).	UNPAPERED status; never assume a deal exists.
Facts inside unopened attachments (C1, C2, C4).	Terms are taken from the executed PDF, not from email summaries.

Where the follow-up timing comes from

The historical record shows long silences (weeks to months), not a working cadence, so the timers in this SOP are **Vox Nova policy**, set tighter than history on purpose:

- Standard request: FU1 at 3 business days, FU2 3 business days later, escalate 2 business days after FU2 (8 business days total).
- Payment: first check 10 business days after the invoice is acknowledged (or on the date the label promised, if sooner).
- Release countdown: escalate at ≤ 10 business days to release with any gate item open.

The Escalation Owner can change these in `../README.md` → Settings.